

Sample Syllabus: Applied Business Economics

BECO 3310-001
MWF 8:00–8:50 AM
Rawls College of Business 00101
Fall 2025
Lecture

Instructor Information

Instructor: David Crego
Offices: Rawls NW 307; Free Market Institute 166 (Administration Building)
Office Hours: 9:00–11:00 AM, MWF, Rawls NW307; otherwise by appointment
Email: dcrego@ttu.edu
Class website: Raider Canvas

Course Description:

The purpose of this course is to teach students how the economic way of thinking informs business decisions and strategy. I am using the textbook *Universal Economics* by Armen Alchian and William Allen. This textbook does a good job explaining economic reasoning and how to apply it. The in-class assignments will test your comprehension of core economic concepts and ability to apply these concepts to open-ended problems.

Required materials:

The course text is *Universal Economics*, by Armen A. Alchian and William R. Allen. It is available for free (html and pdf) [here](#). I also recommend you purchase a hard copy, but this is not mandatory.

This text is challenging. Reading it will require you to think hard. I recommend you read each chapter twice: quickly the first time, to get a general impression, and slowly the second time, to digest the ideas.

Finally, you should subscribe to *Economic Forces*, a Substack newsletter published by Dr. Brian Albrecht and Dr. Joshua Hendrickson. You can sign up [here](#). An archive of the most relevant entries can be found [here](#).

Prerequisites:

High school mathematics and a Principles of Economics course, with a grade of C- or higher. I expect students to have working knowledge of introductory microeconomics. If you need a

refresher, watch the videos at [Marginal Revolution University](#). Focus on the Principles of Microeconomics unit.

Instruction Method:

Lecture and discussion. My lectures will be based on personal notes. These notes will not be made available to students, but class lecture slides will be available on Canvas.

Expected Learning Outcomes:

After completing this course, students will be able to:

- Demonstrate ability to apply supply and demand analysis to competitive markets.
 - Comprehend and apply the concept of elasticity to demand and supply, and illustrate how this concept can improve forecasts and analysis in applied business settings.
 - Demonstrate proficiency with the concepts of economic costs and cost minimization, profit maximization as a guiding principle, and the bilateral discipline the firm and market exert on each other in a contestable market.
 - Identify causes of creating and maintaining market power, and how market power might be used by a firm. This includes understanding the spectrum of market power from pure monopoly to perfectly competitive markets.
 - Recognize and evaluate intended and unintended consequences of government intervention in markets, and the direct and indirect impact on individual firms.
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Assignments

Class participation will be given for attending the specified class times. Due to the large number of students enrolled in the class, I will not take a daily attendance call at the beginning of class. However, if I observe a low attendance rate (around 60%), then I reserve the right to issue daily quizzes that grade for class participation.

On specified Fridays, you will be solving problems in class. You may work in groups of up to four for Friday classwork. Your grade will partly depend on completion (participation) and partly on correctness. You will need Bluebooks for the assignments. Collectively, these assignments are worth **30% of your final semester grade**.

There will be three exams this semester, two midterms and the final exam. Although there are three scheduled exams, I will drop the lowest exam score from your final grade. The format for the exams is short answers for open-ended questions, not multiple choice. You will need Bluebooks for the exams. Each of the counted exams is worth **30% of your final semester grade**.

<u>Assignment</u>	<u>Weight:</u>
Class participation	10%
Friday in-class assignments	30%
Two Highest Exams	60%

Extra Credit

You can earn extra credit by attending public lectures sponsored by the [Free Market Institute at Texas Tech University](#). There are three lectures scheduled: **September 17, October 28, and December 2**. If you attend a lecture **and write a one-page summary of the talk**, you can earn two percent extra credit per talk. If you attend and write summaries of all three, your final semester grade will be six percent (more than half a letter grade) higher. This is often the difference between a B+ and an A-.

Grade Scale

90%-100% A, 80%-89.9% B, etc. Pluses and minuses will be assigned to grades received in the upper and lower third of each decile. **Rounding grades in any direction is solely my prerogative.**

Exams:

Two midterm exams will be administered during class, and a final exam will occur during the designated final exam schedule. They will be based on course text chapters and lectures. **Anything in a chapter is fair game, even if we do not explicitly cover it in class.**

The format will be short-answer questions. The questions will require you to demonstrate economic proficiency in written, mathematical, and graphing forms. Bring a Bluebook to class on exam day.

Here is the planned exam schedule:

Midterm exam 1 (Demand)—September 26, in class

Midterm exam 2 (Supply)—October 22, in class

Final Exam:

The final exam will use the same format as your previous exams. **The final exam is not cumulative.**

The date and time of your final exam is **TBD**

Course Communication:

Course announcements will be made in class and posted to Raider Canvas. The course syllabus will also be posted to Raider Canvas. If you do not know your score on an assignment because

you miss class the day an assignment is handed back, you can come to office hours to discuss your score.

Students may always email me with any questions.

Syllabus Statements:

Information about ADA, academic integrity, religious holy day accommodation, and pregnant student accommodations can be found here:

<https://www.depts.ttu.edu/tlpdc/RequiredSyllabusStatements.php>

Tentative Course Schedule

Date	Unit	Chapters	Class
8/25/25	Introduction	Syllabus and Class Expectations	1
8/27/25	1	Chapter 1: Welcome to Economics	2
8/29/25	1	Chapter 2: Your Economic Society	3
9/1/25		Labor Day, NO CLASS	
9/3/25	1	Chapter 3: Costs and Choice	4
9/5/25		Problem Set 1	
9/8/25	2	Chapter 4: Gains from Exchange	5
9/10/25	2	Chapter 5: Demand and the Laws of Demand	6
9/12/25	2	Chapter 6: The Extent of Exchange	7
9/15/25	3	Chapter 7: Keep Your Eyes on the Marginals	8
9/17/25	3	Chapter 8: More Features of Demand Chapter 9: Some Implications of Laws of Demand	9
9/19/25		Problem Set 2	
9/22/25	4	Chapter 10: Markets and Prices as Social Coordinators Chapter 11: Illustrative Applications of Demand Principles	10
9/24/25		Exam 1 Review	
9/26/25		Exam 1: Demand	
9/29/25	5	Chapter 14: Productivity and Costs of Production	11
10/1/25	5	Chapter 15: Specialization, Production, Teams, and Firms	12
10/3/25	6	Chapter 16: Market Supply and Price with Price-Takers	13
10/6/25	6	Chapter 17: Timing of Adjustments	14
10/8/25	6	Chapter 18: Facts of Life	15
10/10/25		Problem Set 3	
10/13/25	7	Chapter 19: Price-Searchers	16
10/15/25	7	Chapter 20: Price-Searcher Pricing	17
10/17/25	7	Chapter 21: Pricing and Marketing Tactics	18

10/20/25		Exam 2 Review	
10/22/25		Exam 2: Supply	
10/24/25		No Class: Instructor Sick	
10/27/25	8	Chapter 22: Teamwork and Firms Chapter 23: The Firm's Control and Reward Structure	19
10/29/25	9	Chapter 24: Protecting Your Dependencies Chapter 25: Dependency Assurance by Reputation and Predictable Prices	20
10/31/25	9	Chapter 26: Prohibited Marketing Tactics	21
11/3/25	10	Chapter 27: The Corporate Firm Chapter 28: Competition for Control of the Corporation	22
11/5/25	10	Chapter 29: The Demand for Productive Resources	23
11/7/25		Problem Set 4	
11/10/25	11	Chapter 30: Arithmetic of Capital Values Chapter 31: Future Values and Annuities	24
11/12/25	12	Chapter 32: Wealth, Income, and Interest	25
11/14/25	12	Chapter 33: Rate of Interest Chapter 34: Risk and Insurance	26
11/17/25	13	Chapter 36: Determinants of the Interest Rate Chapter 37: Futures Markets	27
11/19/25		Optional Problem Set 5	28
11/21/25		NO CLASS: Instructor Out of Town	
11/24/25		NO CLASS: Thanksgiving Week	
11/26/25		NO CLASS: THANKSGIVING WEEK	
11/28/25		NO CLASS: THANKSGIVING WEEK	
12/1/25		Final Review	29
12/3/25		Final Review	30

This schedule is *tentative*, meaning it can be subject to change. I reserve the right to modify this schedule if necessary. If I do so a revised syllabus will be posted on Canvas, and you will be notified of this both in class and via email.

Required TTU syllabus statements (ADA, academic integrity, religious holy days, pregnancy accommodation) are included in the full course syllabus.